

box against "Automatically perform basic compression on Save". You can also change the density (pixels per inch) of the images saved.

Keep in mind this option will be set only for the current presentation — which means you have to do this over again when you work on another presentation.

Resize Proportionately

When you want to resize items in a slide, instead of doing so individually, and ruining the aspect ratios, you can just select multiple objects by [Shift] + Clicking on them to select them and then resizing using your mouse to drag the corners. Remember to keep [Shift] pressed in order to make sure that individual aspect ratios are maintained. This works with both text and pictures. So just select and resize without worry!

Changing Resolutions On The Fly

Large presentations with high-resolution images can be a burden on slower machines. To avoid any embarrassment during presentations, PowerPoint has a useful feature that can switch resolutions of the presentations down to more manageable levels.

Click on the Slide Show tab on the ribbon. Under Monitors, click the Resolution dropdown and select a suitable resolution. The next time you run the slideshow, the resolution will be switched to the one specified by you.

Viewing Sizes

This tip applies throughout Office 2007, and relates to the Zoom feature. Most of us use [Ctrl] + mouse scroll down/up to zoom in or out. However, this does so in increments of 10 per cent. For obsessive compulsive people like those of us here at *Digit*, we often find our documents zooming to just inside the screen boundaries or just out of it. In such cases the perfect zoom might be something like 154 per cent. Using the Zoom slider on the bottom right of the Office application window, you can achieve these exact zoom levels.

The Developer Tab

The Developer tab in PowerPoint is a hidden tab in the ribbon. It allows you to create and run or edit macros. To



enable it, click on the Office button and then PowerPoint Options button. Under the Popular section, check the box against Show Developer tab in the Ribbon. Click OK to save the changes. The Developer bar will appear in the ribbon on top and can be accessed by clicking on the tab.

Create Photo Albums With PowerPoint

Creating photo albums can be an onerous chore for some of us. PowerPoint 2007 has a feature that lets you create a photo slideshow within seconds. First click on the Insert tab in the ribbon. Click the Photo Album icon and choose New Photo Album. Click the File/Disk button to add images



Add images stored on your hard drive to create a Photo Album

to the album. Select the photos you want in the slideshow and click Insert. You can use the up and down arrows here to change the order of the photos. You can also alter the brightness, contrast and orientation of the images. When you are done, click the Create button and your Photo Album is ready. You can now continue adding notes to each slide.

Recording Narrations

PowerPoint lets you record a voiceover for slides — which can be useful if you're not making your presentation to a live audience.

To record a narration, first click the Slide Show tab in the ribbon. Click the Record Narration icon. Here you have the option to change the microphone volume, quality and where the file should be saved. Click OK once you're done with the changes. Click the Current Slide button if you want to

record a voiceover starting from the current slide, or click the First Slide button if you want to start from the very beginning. The slideshow will then start and you can start speaking into the microphone. Click to switch to the next slide and continue speaking as necessary. When all the slides are done, you'll be asked whether you want to save the timings for each slide. Click Save.

Accurate Placement

Placing elements and then aligning them, or accurately placing them can be a little irritating. The easier way is to click the object and use the direction keys to move them into place. Holding down [Ctrl] while you do this gives you pixel-accurate movement — which means you can move them even more accurately. Don't forget to use gridlines to align objects better — under the View tab, check the box against Gridlines.

Page Setup For Presentations

Depending on the type of projector or screen you use or the impact you need to deliver with a presentation, it is wise to change the resolution of the presentation. For example, presentations at standard 4:3 resolutions will look awkward on widescreens.

To change the page setup, simply go to the View tab in the ribbon and then click on Slide Master. Click on the Page setup icon and you will be able to select from a range of presets, or you can enter your own custom size.

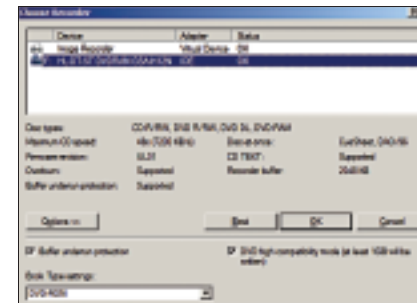
If you've chosen one of the ready-made design themes or even created one by yourself, you should be a little careful while changing the page setup — it can wreak havoc on the design.

NERO 8

Nero Burning ROM happens to be the most widely used application for burning CD/DVDs, and a copy comes bundled with all writers. But the new version is brimming with features which you should know about.

Better Compatibility

One of the issues with media and the way they are burned is that is that they're not always compatible on all DVD players. There are a few things that can be done to solve this: one of them is to set the high compatibility mode on for your drive. Click on the



High compatibility mode significantly reduces the number of coasters you make

Choose Recorder button to the right of the dropdown menu for selecting the drive. Select your drive and click on Options. Check the box against DVD High Compatibility Mode. This will make sure that at least gigabyte of data is written on the media even if you don't have that much data.

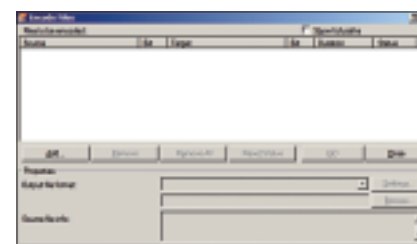
Another thing you can do is to use the Book Type settings — this is basically is to tell the drive that you have inserted a DVD-ROM (for example) not a DVD-RW or any other kind of DVD. This way, there are better chances of the drive reading your media. Use the dropdown menu for Book Type settings in the drive properties window and select DVD-ROM as it generally gives better compatibility.

Move The Cache Folder

Nero uses a location on the hard drive when it needs to cache files before burning them. If you are running short on space in your main partition you will want to change it to one with more free space. Go to File > Options > Cache and click on Browse to choose a new location.

Encode Audio Files

Nero Burning ROM comes with an in-built audio encoder: go to Extras > Encode Files, click on Add and select the files you want to encode. Using the dropdown menu for Output file format, select which format you



The Inbuilt encoder can rip audio CDs directly without additional steps

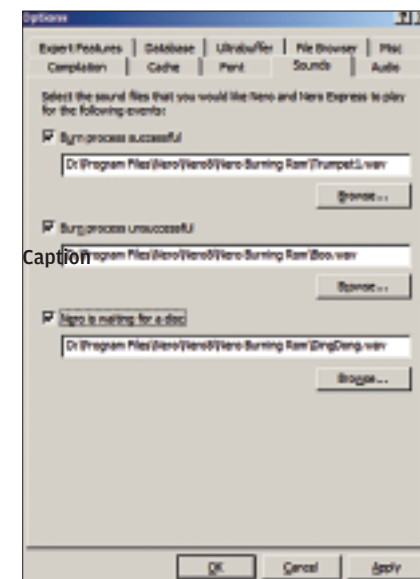
want to encode to and click on the Settings button to set parameters for the encoder. Finally, click on the Browse button to select where you want to store the encoded files once encoded. Click Go to start encoding!

Nero BurnRights

Nero BurnRights is an application that comes with Nero that allows you to define which users on your system can burn CDs and DVDs. Go to Start > All Programs > Nero 8 > Nero Toolkit > Nero BurnRights. Select the type of users that you want to give permission to, and click OK.

Sounds For Events

Nero has support for sounds but they are disabled by default. Go to File > Options > Sounds tab to set sounds for the events. The sounds



Sounds alerts are useful when burning CDs or DVDs in the background

that come with Nero are in the default locations, but you can select the ones you want by clicking the Browse button.

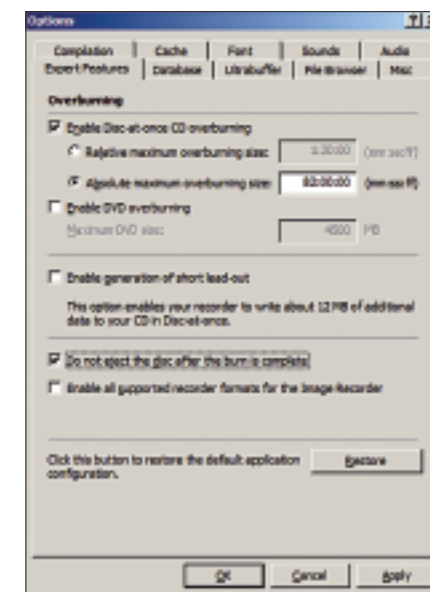
Searching For Specific Formats

Trying to search for a few selected file types you need to burn can be a nightmare in an un-assorted folder. To look for a particular file using wild cards, right click on the folder in the left pane of the browser window. Click on Select pattern. Enter wildcards with semi-colons [;] as separators and click OK. For

example, entering "Digit*.PDF" as the pattern will select all files with Digit in it, and all PDFs as well.

Do Not Eject The CD/DVD

Every CD burned is immediately ejected from the drive by default. To keep the CD or DVD in the drive once it's done, go to File > Options > Expert Features. Check the box against Do not eject the disc after the burn is complete and click OK.



You can stop Nero from auto-ejecting the burnt media

Lean Mean Nero

We all miss the Nero Burning ROM from the past years when it was a compact little CD / DVD burning software and not a complete suite with modules we never use. It's reached a point where there are tiny hacked illegal releases of Nero Burning ROM made available on the Internet which take a fraction of the space of the entire suite. If you have the nasty habit of blindly clicking Next during the Nero 8 installation, you'll most probably have skipped the screen where you choose the Custom installation mode. Uninstall your current copy of Nero if you have it installed. Start the installation till you reach the window where you can choose between Typical and Custom installation. Select the Custom install option and click Next. You'll soon see a window with the list of all the Nero components selected. Click on each one of them and select This Feature Will Not Be